NO.60 家族で食事をすることの重要性(2)

How and why did the family meal start to disappear in the United States? My friends in the United States have various explanations why meals together aren't an option for their families. Parents and children lead "hectic lives and there just isn't time for a sit-down meal. Kids' sports schedules run on into dinner hour. After a long day at work, parents are too tired to cook. Teenagers are off on their own after school. "Everyone likes different foods" they say, "so what is the point of eating together?"

Yet study after study shows that having meals together as a family is good for both adults and children. A University of Michigan study found that mealtime at home was the single strongest factor predicting better achievement scores and fewer behavioral problems for children. Mealtime was far more powerful than time spent in school, studying, worshiping, playing sports or doing arts activities.

Other studies show that children like family meals. In one report, nearly four-fifths of adolescents cited eating dinner at home as one of their top-rated family activities. In a national YMCA poll in 2000, when teenagers were asked about their worries, 21 percent rated "not having enough time with parents" as their top concern.

---

*　hectic「大忙しの」

1	option	名詞	選択肢・選択(権の自由)
2	adopt	他動詞	を採用する・を養子にする
3	kid	名詞・自動詞	子供・冗談を言う
4	kindergarten	名詞	幼稚園
5	schedule	名詞・他動詞	スケジュール・を予定する
6	routine	名詞・形容詞	日課・型通りの
7	scheme	名詞・自動詞・他動詞	計画・悪だくみ・企む
8	teenager	名詞	10 代の若者
9	single	形容詞	まさに・ただ 1 つの・個々の・独身の
10	sole	形容詞	唯一の・単独の
11	mere	形容詞	単なる・ほんの
12	factor	名詞	要因・因子
13	element	名詞	要素・元素・自然の力
14	predict	他動詞	を予言する・を予測する
15	forecast	他動詞	を予報する・予想する・予報・予測
16	achievement	名詞	学業(成績)・業績・達成
17	accomplish	他動詞	を成し遂げる
18	attain	他動詞	を成し遂げる・に達する
19	score	名詞・自動詞・他動詞	(試合・試験の)得点・楽譜・得点する
20	far	形容詞・副詞	大いに・(時間・空間的に)遠くへ・遠い
21	worship	自動詞・他動詞・名詞	礼拝する・を崇拝する・崇拝・礼拝
22	art	名詞	芸術(作品)・美術・技術
23	nearly	副詞	ほとんど
24	adolescent	名詞・形容詞	青年・青年期の
25	cite	他動詞	を引用する・を挙げる
26	quote	他動詞	を引用する
27	poll	名詞・自動詞・他動詞	世論調査・投票・投票する
28	pole	名詞	棒・(地球・天体の)極

29	rate	他動詞・名詞	を評価する・割合・速度・料金
30	pace	名詞	歩調・進度
31	enough	形容詞・副詞・代名詞	十分な・十分に・必要なだけの数量

1	option	
2	adopt	
3	kid	
4	kindergarten	
5	schedule	
6	routine	
7	scheme	
8	teenager	
9	single	
10	sole	
11	mere	
12	factor	
13	element	
14	predict	
15	forecast	
16	achievement	
17	accomplish	
18	attain	
19	score	
20	far	
21	worship	
22	art	
23	nearly	
24	adolescent	
25	cite	
26	quote	
27	poll	
28	pole	

29	rate	
30	pace	
31	enough	
32		
33		
34		
35		
36		